Business Management HL · Set B · Paper 3

Worked mark scheme · 75 minutes · 25 marks

Award equivalent valid methods and conclusions. Apply the indicated mark allocation to each part. Credit consistent follow-through where the subsequent reasoning remains valid.

NightBridge · Social enterprise [25]

(a) **[2]**

Using one motivation theory, describe a human need that NightBridge helps a driver meet.

1 mark · Identify a relevant need and theory, such as relatedness under Alderfer or belonging under Maslow.

1 mark · The driver's role connects her to workers who depend on the service. Accept esteem or another need if convincingly linked to the evidence.

(b) **[6]**

Explain two challenges NightBridge faces in maintaining social and financial sustainability.

1 mark · The unrestricted cash buffer is CU 30,000.

1 mark · At CU 3,000 per month it reaches the floor after ten months without improvement.

1 mark · The council grant is restricted to training and cannot cover the recurring deficit.

1 mark · The employer adds full-fare journeys and displaces eligible passengers during peak hours.

1 mark · The initial timetable gives 17,400 concession journeys out of 34,800, or 50%, below 60%.

1 mark · Accepting without redesign could breach the constitution precisely when shift workers need access. Credit other distinct applied challenges, up to three marks each.

(c) **[17]**

Recommend a two-year plan of action that improves NightBridge's finances while meeting its social purpose. Refer to all the resources and use relevant business management tools or theory.

4 marks · Resource use (0–4). At 1 refer to a resource, at 2 apply some case evidence, at 3 connect most of it to the plan, at 4 integrate all four resources. Link peak capacity, driver motivation, the cash floor, the employer's offer, the survey and the restricted grant to decisions.

4 marks · Tools and theory (0–4). Move from naming a tool (1) to partial application (2), sound application (3) and effective decision use (4). Paying CU 15,000 leaves CU 27,000 before month-one operations, then CU 24,000 at the end of that month. From month 2 the full offer produces a net CU 2,500 monthly surplus. It violates the concession condition as offered. At existing full-fare volumes of 17,400 after expansion, meeting 60% would require 26,100 concession journeys, 8,700 above the initial forecast. Adjust either side of that ratio and re-cost the revised timetable.

6 marks · Evaluation (0–6). Award 1–2 for an asserted option, 3–4 for comparing plausible effects, and 5–6 for a case-specific judgement that weighs feasibility, stakeholder effects and uncertainties. Negotiate off-peak timing, a cap on full-fare capacity or employer support for additional concession seats. Extra training alone cannot fund wages. The pilot and two-night survey give incomplete evidence, so consult workers on other shifts and monitor missed pickups. Holding the full contract until revised cash and journey targets are credible is defensible.

3 marks · Action and sequence (0–3). Award 1 for isolated actions, 2 for a workable sequence, 3 for linked milestones and contingencies. Before signing, agree financing, timings and protected concessions. Monitor cash, service access and driver retention monthly during the pilot. Scale only once forecasts clear the CU 12,000 floor and the 60% test. During year two diversify employers and seek replacement training support if the council or manufacturer withdraws. Accept other supported sequences and conclusions.

End of mark scheme · 25 marks